

## PART ONE

# The Light Within You

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اللَّهُ نُورُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ ۚ مَثَلُ نُورِهِ كَمِشْكَاةٍ فِيهَا مِصْبَاحٌ

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*Allāhu nūru s-samāwāti wa-l-ard, mathalu nūrihi ka-mishkātīn fihā miṣbāḥ*

*Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth. The likeness of His light is as a niche in which there is a lamp.*

SŪRAT AN-NŪR • 24:35

Later in the same ayah, Allah says:

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نُورٌ عَلَى نُورٍ ۚ يَهْدِي اللَّهُ لِنُورِهِ مَن يَشَاءُ

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*“Light upon light. Allah guides to His light whom He wills.”*

Sūrat an-Nūr • 24:35

Guidance comes from Allah. Like dawn breaking through the night, it reaches the heart quietly, revealing what was hidden and showing the way forward.

His guidance reaches the heart quietly, revealing what was hidden and showing the way forward. This nūr is not a flame we awaken on our own, but a mercy He gently places within us.

The Prophet ﷺ made that dependence personal in du‘ā: “O Allah, place light in my heart.” He also asked Allah for light in his sight and hearing, before him and behind him, above him and below him, and asked Allah to grant him light. (Sahih al-Bukhari 6316; Sahih Muslim 763.) That is the meaning behind the title The Light Within You: not a light we create for ourselves or possess, but light we ask Allah to place in the heart and around us.

We often spend years looking outside ourselves for something that will finally make life feel steady. A better routine. An easier path. Fewer demands. More certainty. But some of the steadiness we keep

searching for becomes harder to cultivate when we overlook the capacities Allah has already given us and the guidance; He has placed within our reach.

The work of these first four chapters is not to build a different person from the ground up. It is to help you use those capacities more consciously, under the guidance Allah has given, when life becomes demanding.

And life will become demanding.

Responsibilities will pile up. Relationships will test us. Plans will change. Some problems will refuse to be resolved on schedule. A steadier life does not mean the room stops moving. It means pressure does not have to decide what happens inside you or what comes out of you next.

Part One begins in that small space. That is where the work starts.

*In these four chapters: Tafakkur · Muraqabah · Sabr · Tawakkul*

*Part One opens with the light of Allah, and it is fitting to begin by asking the Almighty, Lord of the heavens and the earth through the very words taught to us by the Prophet ﷺ.*

اللَّهُمَّ اجْعَلْ فِي قَلْبِي نُورًا، وَفِي لِسَانِي نُورًا، وَاجْعَلْ فِي سَمْعِي نُورًا، وَاجْعَلْ فِي بَصَرِي  
نُورًا، وَاجْعَلْ مِنْ خَلْفِي نُورًا، وَمِنْ أَمَامِي نُورًا، وَاجْعَلْ مِنْ فَوْقِي نُورًا، وَمِنْ تَحْتِي نُورًا  
اللَّهُمَّ أَعْظِنِي نُورًا.

*Allāhumma-j'al fī qalbī nūran, wa fī lisānī nūran, waj'al fī sam'ī nūran, waj'al fī baṣarī nūran,  
waj'al min khalfī nūran, wa min amāmī nūran, waj'al min fawqī nūran, wa min taḥtī nūran.*

*Allāhumma a'ṭinī nūran.*

**O Allah, place light in my heart and light in my tongue. Place light in my hearing and light in my sight. Place light behind me and before me, above me and beneath me. O Allah, grant me light.**

*Sahih Muslim 763.*

**Āmīn.**